



Is all play and no work making Jack a dull boy?

Tablets, smartphones and gaming devices such as Nintendo DS, Wii and PS3 are gifted to them not only as a means of entertainment, but also to buy that little bit of momentary peace of mind for the adults. Basically, a “shut-up toy” (an actual industry term) to occupy them during daily routines such as errands, car rides and eating out.

It is said that the smarter the toy, the lesser challenged the kid. Everything is done at the click of a button or rather the tap of a screen nowadays. Even easy access to information could potentially be spoiling the younger generation, with spoon-fed solutions from Google and an abundance of even information of the wrong kind.

But is exposure to technology all bad? After all, we at Digit live and breathe technology 24/7, and we can't possibly condone something that's obviously detrimental let alone dedicate an entire FastTrack to it. Rest assured as always there is a flipside and in this case an upside.

There is enough research on the pro-technology side that suggests exposure to technology is in fact good for children. Take the most cited example of gaming. Research suggests gaming aids in multi-tasking, analytical ability, decision making and self control.

Think of the first generation that grappled with embracing technological innovations like the telephone or television. It did take getting used to. Many